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Auto Remarketing Today

TUESDAY, OCT. 8, 2026 — The News Media of the Pre-Owned Industry

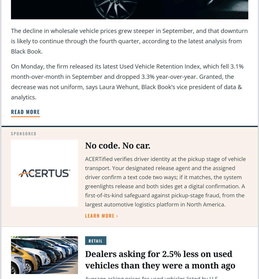


WHOLESALE

Wholesale used-car prices drop more than 3% in September

Black Book's retention index fell 3.1% month-over-month, and the firm expects the slide to run through the fourth quarter

BY AUTO REMARKETING STAFF



The decline in wholesale vehicle prices grew steeper in September, and that downturn is likely to continue through the fourth quarter, according to the latest analysis from Black Book.

On Monday, the firm released its latest Used Vehicle Retention Index, which fell 3.1% month-over-month in September and dropped 3.3% year-over-year. Granted, the decrease was not uniform, says Laura Wehunt, Black Book's vice president of data & analytics.

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RETAIL

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Dealership M&A moves from Mountain West to Atlantic Coast

Young Automotive Group has sold its Young Chrysler Dodge Jeep Ram and Young GMC dealerships in Burley, Idaho, to Mountain West Auto Group, according to Performance Brokerage Services, which advised on the sale. Young was founded in 1924 and now includes more than 30 automotive, powersports and truck & trailer stores across Utah, Idaho and Montana.

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Lane watch: Rising fuel costs leaving mark on values, volume & conversion rate

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AUCTIONS

NAAA names next leadership rotation, Hall of Fame inductee, Industry Pioneer & more

At its World Remarketing Convention in Seattle, the National Auto Auction Association elected Lisa Franz as its vice president for the 2026-2027 term. This begins a four-year leadership progression for Franz, who is general manager and co-founder of Big Valley Auto Auction in Donna, Texas, which she and her family opened in 2008. She will serve as president-elect for 2027-2028, president for 2028-2029 and chair the board in 2029-2030.

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DATA & ANALYTICS

JD Power: Brand loyalty stays strong amid economic headwinds

Loyalty averaged 50.2% across all nameplates and segments, up from 49% a year ago.



TECHNOLOGY

DriveCentric introduces Acquire Agent for real-time acquisition

The company started October by adding to its growing portfolio of native AI agents.



DATA & ANALYTICS

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TECHNOLOGY

ITOCHU invests in MOTER again to leverage connected-car technology

If you didn't believe the modern vehicles you're financing, retailing or repairing are smartphones rolling on four wheels, perhaps this investment announcement will sway your opinion. MOTER Technologies, an AI-powered investment delivering a connected-vehicle data platform, said it gained an additional strategic investment from ITOCHU Corp., one of Japan's leading general trading companies.

TECHNOLOGY

With AI agent adoption growing, IgniteUps.ai rolls out one with critical dealership tasks in mind

The company introduced NEXUS, designed to be an automotive AI performance manager built to orchestrate a dealership's connected AI workforce and execute real work across its systems. "Every dealership manager has asked, 'What can we do to sell a car today?' NEXUS is built to help answer that question and then help execute," founder and CEO Chris Martinez said.

DATA & ANALYTICS

COMMENTARY: Dealers don't have an inventory problem; they have a decision problem

The past several years reshaped the economics of automotive retail, creating operating conditions that were never likely to last. Dealers who thrived on thin supply and outsized margins are now addressing a harder environment: rising floorplan costs, more price-sensitive consumers and compressed per-vehicle gross. The ones who outperform will recognize when a vehicle is starting to show signs of risk, and act while there are still options.

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Know more before you make the first call

The IQ Advantage: recommended strategy, disposable income, distance to dealer, site viewed VDPs and much, much more. Protomiq is the conversion and experience platform for auto dealers, turning shopper behavior — searches, trade valuations, payment calculations — into purchase intent your sales and service teams can act on.

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The past several years reshaped the economics of automotive retail, creating operating conditions that were never likely to last. Dealers who thrive on thin supply and outsized margins are now facing a more normalized environment. Disruption costs, once a temporary condition, have become a compressed per-vehicle gross. The ones who outperform will recognize when a vehicle is starting to show signs of risk, and act while there are still options.

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